

“We shall ... **organize and discipline** an army ... and go on to victory or sustain defeat.”

DIARY ENTRY OF JOSIAH MARSHALL FAVILL, 71ST NEW YORK, AFTER BULL RUN

## **Mixed results**

The Union Army of the Potomac's mixed performance on the battlefield proved that excellence on the parade ground did not necessarily translate into victory. Indeed, McClellan's cautious temperament had a stronger influence on the Army of the Potomac's command culture than did his training program. As Lieutenant Colonel Alexander S. Webb put it after the Battle of Chancellorsville, his hesitancy helped to create an army in which most of the leaders were “cautious, stupid and without any dash.” They “delay 20,000 men ... in order to skirmish with 20 or 30 cav[alr]y and one piece of art[iller]y. They all think the enemy wiser and braver and quicker than themselves and such men should not command.”

Webb would not have attributed this failing to McClellan's temperament, but the Army of the Potomac did have an overly defensive mindset, which would remain a problem even after General Ulysses S. Grant took over command during the Overland Campaign in summer 1864.